Features

Everything StaffSync can do today, grouped by module. Roles: HR = HR administrator, MGR = manager, EMP = employee.

StaffSync digitises everyday HR work for an organisation. All features below are implemented end to end: React screen, REST API, validation, authorization and MongoDB storage. Items that are intentionally missing are listed at the end.

1. Authentication and accounts

Secure access for three roles, with no self-service role selection.

Feature	What it does	Roles	Key rules
Login / logout	Email and password sign-in; session stored in an HttpOnly cookie (8 hours).	All	Same error for wrong email or password; deactivated accounts are blocked.
First HR administrator setup	One-time page that creates the first HR account.	Setup key holder	Needs SETUP_KEY; works only while the database has no users.
Invitation links	HR creates an employee; the system gives a one-time link; the employee sets a password.	HR, all	Token stored hashed, valid 7 days, single use.
Profile and password	View profile; edit own name and phone; change password.	All	Role, manager, department and ID are HR-controlled. Password change ends other sessions.
Protection	Rate limiting on login routes, CSRF header, validation of every input.	All	20 attempts per 15 minutes per IP on login-type routes.

2. Employee management

HR keeps the single source of truth for who works in the organisation.

Feature	What it does	Roles	Key rules
Create and edit employees	Name, work email, employee ID, role, department, job title, manager, joining date, employment type, phone.	HR	Unique email and employee ID; ID auto-generated if left blank.
Search, filter, sort, paginate	Search by name, email or ID; filter by department, role, status; sort; 10 per page.	HR, MGR	Managers see only their own team.
Activate / deactivate	Turn an account off or on without deleting history.	HR	Cannot deactivate yourself or the last active HR.
Employee profile page	Profile, leave balances and recent attendance of one person.	HR, MGR	Manager access limited to direct reports.
Invite link regeneration	New link for someone who has not activated yet.	HR	Only for not-yet-activated accounts.

3. Departments

Feature	What it does	Roles	Key rules
Department CRUD	Create, rename, describe and delete departments; see active headcount.	HR	Name and code unique; cannot delete a department that still has employees or announcements.

4. Attendance

Self-service check-in and check-out with rules enforced on the server.

Feature	What it does	Roles	Key rules
Check in / check out	Daily buttons with live status and times.	All	One check-in per day; check-out needs a check-in and works once.
Late detection	Check-in after work start plus grace period is marked late.	All	Default 09:30 + 15 minutes, configurable.

Feature	What it does	Roles	Key rules
Weekends and holidays	No attendance recorded on non-working days or approved leave days.	All	WEEKEND_DAYS and HOLIDAYS settings.
Missed check-out	Past days with no check-out are flagged, not guessed.	All	Shown as Missed; counted in reports.
History and filters	Personal history; team or organisation records filtered by employee and dates.	All / MGR / HR	Times shown in the organisation timezone.

5. Leave management

Request, review and balance tracking without spreadsheets.

Feature	What it does	Roles	Key rules
Apply for leave	Casual, sick or earned leave with dates and a reason.	All	Working days only; no overlaps; cannot exceed available balance; no past start (sick may be backdated 7 days).
Approve / reject	Reviewer sees pending requests and approves or rejects with a reason.	HR, MGR	HR any request except own; manager only direct reports; never your own.
Cancel	Withdraw a pending request or an approved one that has not started.	Owner	Approved days are returned to the balance.
Balances	Remaining days per leave type for the year.	All; HR/MGR view others	Deducted only on approval, atomically.
Leave calendar	Month grid of approved leave: organisation, team or personal.	All	Scope depends on role.
Balance adjustment (API)	HR changes yearly allocation for one person.	HR	Cannot go below days already used.

6. Announcements

Feature	What it does	Roles	Key rules
Create, edit, publish, archive	HR drafts a message, publishes it and later archives it.	HR	Archived items cannot be edited.
Targeting	Send to everyone or only selected departments.	HR	Empty selection means the whole organisation.
Reading	Employees and managers see only published items meant for them.	All	Publishing creates notifications.

7. Notifications

Feature	What it does	Roles	Key rules
In-app notifications	Bell with unread count, dropdown, full list, mark one or all as read.	All	Events: leave submitted, approved or rejected; announcement published; training published. No email or SMS.

8. Training and development

Feature	What it does	Roles	Key rules
Create and manage programs	Title, description, schedule, location, capacity; draft, publish, archive.	HR, MGR	Managers manage only programs they created.
Enroll / cancel	Employees join a published program and may cancel before it starts.	All	No duplicate enrolment; seats cannot exceed capacity (0 = unlimited).
Enrollees list	See who joined a program.	HR, MGR (own)	Shows name, ID, department, date.
My enrollments	Personal list of joined programs.	All	Includes start time and location.

9. Dashboards

Every number comes from the database; nothing is hard-coded.

Feature	What it does	Roles	Key rules
HR dashboard	Active employees, today attendance (in, late, on leave, absent), pending leave, department chart, 14-day trend, leave status chart, activity feed, announcements, trainings.	HR	Absent is derived: not checked in and not on leave on a working day.
Manager dashboard	Team status today, pending approvals, recent team activity, trainings, announcements.	MGR	Limited to direct reports.
Employee dashboard	Profile summary, today check-in and out, leave balances, requests, recent attendance, announcements, trainings.	EMP	Personal data only.

10. Reports and analytics

Backend aggregation queries with date and department filters.

Feature	What it does	Roles	Key rules
Employees by department	Active headcount per department.	HR, MGR	Not date filtered.
Attendance trend and status	Check-ins per day; on-time vs late; missed check-outs.	HR, MGR	Default last 30 days, maximum one year.
Leave by status	Requests and days by status for the period.	HR, MGR	Counted by start date.
Department attendance	Records and average hours per department.	HR, MGR	No performance score is invented.
Training enrollment	Enrolled versus capacity for the latest programs.	HR, MGR	Published programs only.

11. Platform and interface features

- Responsive layout for desktop, tablet and mobile with a collapsible sidebar and top bar (profile menu, notifications).
- Reusable components: data tables, search and filter bars, pagination, modals, confirmation dialogs, toasts, loading, empty and error states.
- Forms with validation and field-level server error messages; labels and keyboard-friendly controls.
- Lazy-loaded pages, server-side pagination, database indexes, centralised error handling.
- Seed script with fictional demo data; automated API and component tests; Postman collection.

Not implemented (by design or time)

- No email or SMS delivery; invitation links are copied by HR. No password reset by email.
- No salary, payroll, bank or government ID data (data minimisation).
- No holiday management screen (holidays are set in configuration) and no screen for adjusting leave balances (API only).
- No GPS or biometric attendance, no night-shift support, no audit log, no multi-factor login.